

STATE OF NEW YORK

6555--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

March 17, 2025

Introduced by Sens. JACKSON, MARTINS -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Civil Service and Pensions -- recommitted to the Committee on Civil Service and Pensions in accordance with Senate Rule 6, sec. 8 -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the retirement and social security law, in relation to providing a heart disease presumption for certain members employed as fire alarm dispatchers

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

Section 1. The retirement and social security law is amended by adding a new section 607-m to read as follows:

§ 607-m. Disabilities of fire alarm dispatchers in certain cases. 1. Notwithstanding the provisions of any general, special or local law or administrative code to the contrary, but except for the purposes of the workers' compensation law and the labor law, any condition of impairment of health caused by diseases of the heart, resulting in total or partial disability or death to a person performing the duties of a fire alarm dispatcher, a supervising fire alarm dispatcher level one or a supervising fire alarm dispatcher level two of a fire department in a city with a population of one million or more, who successfully passed a physical examination on entry into such service or subsequent thereto, which examination failed to reveal any evidence of such condition, shall be presumptive evidence that it was incurred in the performance and discharge of duty, unless the contrary be proved by competent evidence.

2. Notwithstanding any other provision of law, a fire alarm dispatcher, supervising fire alarm dispatcher level one or supervising fire alarm dispatcher level two member of a fire department in a city with a population of one million or more retiring pursuant to the provisions of

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets [-] is old law to be omitted.

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1 subdivision one of this section shall receive a pension equal to three-
 2 fourths of such member's final average salary.

3 § 2. All past service costs associated with implementing the
 4 provisions of this act shall be borne by the city of New York.

5 § 3. Notwithstanding any provision of law to the contrary, none of the
 6 provisions of this act shall be subject to the appropriation requirement
 7 of section 25 of the retirement and social security law.

8 § 4. This act shall take effect immediately.

FISCAL NOTE.--Pursuant to Legislative Law, Section 50:

SUMMARY: This proposed legislation would provide to NYCERS Tier 4 and Tier 6 Fire Alarm Dispatchers a rebuttable statutory presumption that a qualifying disability or death related to heart disease was incurred in the performance of duty and provide a performance of duty disability benefit equal to 75% of the member's Final Average Salary.

ILLUSTRATION - INCREASE (DECREASE) IN EMPLOYER CONTRIBUTIONS
 by Fiscal Year for the first 25 years (\$ in Thousands)

Year	One Incident		One Incident Per Year	
	Disability	Death	Disability	Death
2027	59	42	59	42
2028	59	42	119	85
2029	59	42	181	129
2030	59	42	245	175
2031	59	42	311	222
2032	59	42	379	271
2033	59	42	449	321
2034	59	42	521	372
2035	59	42	596	425
2036	59	42	672	480
2037	59	42	751	536
2038	59	42	832	594
2039	59	42	915	653
2040	59	42	1,002	715
2041	0	0	1,032	736
2042	0	0	1,063	758
2043	0	0	1,094	781
2044	0	0	1,127	804
2045	0	0	1,161	829
2046	0	0	1,196	853
2047	0	0	1,232	879
2048	0	0	1,269	905
2049	0	0	1,307	933
2050	0	0	1,346	961
2051	0	0	1,386	989

Employer contribution impact beyond Fiscal Year 2051 is not shown.

The potential increases in employer contributions will be allocated to New York City.

PRESENT VALUE OF BENEFITS: The Present Value of Benefits is the discounted expected value of benefits paid to current members if all assumptions are met, including future service accrual and pay increases. Future new hires are not included in this present value.

INITIAL INCREASE (DECREASE) IN ACTUARIAL PRESENT VALUES
 as of June 30, 2025 (\$ in Thousands)

Present Value (PV)	Per Disability	Per Death
(1) PV of Employer Contributions:	496	354
(2) PV of Employee Contributions:	(40)	0
Total PV of Benefits (1) + (2):	456	354

UNFUNDED ACCRUED LIABILITY (UAL): Actuarial Accrued Liabilities are the portion of the Present Value of Benefits allocated to past service. Changes in UAL per incident would be recognized as ongoing gain/loss.

AMORTIZATION OF UNFUNDED ACCRUED LIABILITY

Recognized as Ongoing Gain/Loss	Per Disability	Per Death
Increase (Decrease) in UAL:	496 K	354 K
Number of Payments:	14	14
Amortization Payment:	59 K	42 K

CENSUS DATA: The number of members who will benefit in the future from this proposed legislation is unknown. The estimates presented herein are based on preliminary census data collected as of June 30, 2025. The census data for the potentially impacted population used to develop the average costs is summarized below.

NYCERS

Active Members	
- Number Count:	186
- Average Age:	40.6
- Average Service:	12.1
- Average Salary:	89,700

IMPACT ON MEMBER BENEFITS: Currently, active Tier 4 or Tier 6 members of NYCERS who are employed as Fire Alarm Dispatchers and become disabled due to heart disease would generally be eligible for an applicable ordinary disability retirement after attaining 10 years of service. The disability benefit is generally a lifetime payment equal to the greatest of 1/3 of Final Average Salary (FAS), 1/60th of FAS times service, or the service retirement benefit, if eligible.

Under the proposed legislation, the performance of duty disability benefit for Tier 4 or Tier 6 Fire Alarm Dispatcher members who are disabled from heart disease would be equal to 75% of FAS without an offset for Workers' Compensation.

The ordinary death benefit for NYCERS Fire Alarm Dispatchers is a lump sum payment generally equal to three times the member's salary, plus a refund of member contributions. Under the proposed legislation, the performance of duty death benefit would generally be equal to a lifetime benefit of 50% of a member's wages earned during their last year of service, payable to certain beneficiaries.

ASSUMPTIONS AND METHODS: The estimates presented herein have been calculated based on the Revised 2021 Actuarial Assumptions and Methods of the impacted retirement systems.

The number of members who will benefit from this proposed legislation is unknown. The cost of this proposed legislation could vary greatly depending on the number of future members who benefit and on their length of service, age, and salary history. In particular, the increase would be greater for a member who is not yet eligible for an ordinary disability benefit when disabled.

The estimated financial impact for disabled members has been calculated assuming 50% would have retired under the current ordinary disa-

bility benefit, and 50% would have continued working if the proposed legislation were not passed.

RISK AND UNCERTAINTY: The costs presented in this Fiscal Note depend highly on the actuarial assumptions, methods, and models used, demographics of the impacted population, and other factors such as investment, contribution, and other risks. If actual experience deviates from actuarial assumptions, the actual costs could differ from those presented herein. Quantifying these risks is beyond the scope of this Fiscal Note.

This Fiscal Note is intended to measure pension-related impacts and does not include other potential costs (e.g., administrative and Other Postemployment Benefits). This Fiscal Note does not reflect any chapter laws that may have been enacted during the current legislative session.

STATEMENT OF ACTUARIAL OPINION: Marek Tyszkiewicz and Gregory Zelikovsky are members of the Society of Actuaries and the American Academy of Actuaries. We are members of NYCERS, but do not believe it impairs our objectivity, and we meet the Qualification Standards of the American Academy of Actuaries to render the actuarial opinion contained herein. To the best of our knowledge, the results contained herein have been prepared in accordance with generally accepted actuarial principles and procedures and with the Actuarial Standards of Practice issued by the Actuarial Standards Board.

FISCAL NOTE IDENTIFICATION: This Fiscal Note 2026-41 dated March 13, 2026 was prepared by the Chief Actuary for the New York City Retirement Systems and Pension Funds and is intended for use only during the 2026 Legislative Session.